FROM ACCESS TO EQUITY



WHY THE HANS FOUNDATION'S MODEL MATTERS FOR CSR AND POLICY IN INDIA

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As India advances toward its development goals, marked by improved health indicators, greater affordability & accessibility to quality health care, supported by impactful government initiatives, the next phase of progress lies in furthering equitable access and measurable outcomes.

While significant gains have been made with excellent government initiatives, the focus for The Hans Foundation remain in minimizing health shocks, buttressing educational outcomes, sustaining livelihoods and creating all–inclusive society of persons with disabilities. Responding to these milestones will require the foundation to operate at scale while remaining deeply embedded within communities, collaborate with potential stakeholders including CSRs, and continue aligning with government initiatives.

The Hans Foundation, established in 2009 by Ms. Shweta Rawat and Mr. Manoj Bhargava, as a public charitable trust, represents a model that blends last–mile service delivery with systems strengthening, in close association with government programs, across health, education, livelihood, disability inclusion, and climate action.

A Development Lens Anchored in Scale and Replicability

The Hans Foundation's organizational philosophy is driven by a clear mission to identify and implement scalable and replicable social development projects that address structural barriers to access. Its work aligns closely with meticulously designed government program/schemes to induce positive shifts in multiple Sustainable Development Goals, including poverty reduction, good health and well–being, quality education, gender equality, clean water and sanitation, climate action, and biodiversity conservation.

Rather than operating as isolated welfare interventions, the foundation's programs are designed to complement government systems, strengthen community ownership, and generate evidence for sustained impact, an approach increasingly relevant for outcome driven CSR and public private partnerships.

A Dual Strategy Responding to India's Changing Demographics

One of the foundation's distinguishing features is its two–pronged implementation strategy. Rural programs operate largely in aspirational and high poverty districts, focusing on primary healthcare, nutrition, education continuity, livelihoods, and climate resilience. The urban focused programs are designed to serve floating and migrant populations concentrated in slums and informal settlements.

This dual approach acknowledges the critical policy reality – India's vulnerabilities today are shaped equally by entrenched rural deprivation and rapid urbanization.

Geographic Depth with Institutional Presence

The Hans Foundation currently works across 14 states, 82 districts, and more than 8,000 villages, with programs active in 20 aspirational districts identified by NITI Aayog. Regional offices in Delhi NCR, Jaipur, Guwahati, Dehradun, Ranchi, and Lucknow enable decentralized program management, local partnerships, and real time monitoring.

In urban contexts, the foundation operates in cities with high migrant influx, such as Delhi NCR, Mumbai, Kolkata, Howrah, Hyderabad, and Goa, where access to services remain fragmented and informal livelihoods heighten vulnerability.

Health Systems That Reduce Poverty Not Just Disease

Health constitutes the foundation's largest program portfolio, built around the principle that healthcare must be accessible, affordable, and dignified.

Key interventions include more than 236 Mobile Medical Units delivering primary healthcare directly to underserved communities, 73 dialysis centres supporting patients with chronic kidney disease, and around 11 Primary Health Centres and 48 sub centres (improvements